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COLLEGE SPORTS publicity releases come in all shapes and forms with most of them winding up in nearby wastebaskets instead of print.

Having served a term in the fraternity, this reporter knows how true the above statement is. The woods are full of competent SIDs (Sports Information Directors), but those offering variety in their releases can be counted on one hand.

Two that fit the latter category are Collie J. Nicholson of Grambling College and Eddie Mullins of the University of Texas at El Paso.

Therefore, it was a second look at the envelope letterhead that divulged wordings from Mullins and ETUP. Sure, releases from Mullins and Nicholson get thrown away like the rest, but we like to read 'em first.

Mullins, a lanky cigar-chewing Texas, has a flair of similies. More than just a flair. What he has amounts to is an affliction. This guy can't put two sentences together without working a simile into 'em. At least one.

He doesn't always hit, however. Some are great, some are so-so and by Mullins' admission—some are awful. But one thing is for sure, they're always there.

Dishpan Hands

His latest release to cross this desk deals with a track meet between UTEP and the University of California. From it we learn, metaphorically that Wayne Vandenburg, the UTEP track coach has been on the road so much recently he has dishpan hands from washing his perma-press shirts.

Also, that he is harder to please than a beaver in a cement factory, burdened with more problems than a boxer with sticky shoes and lower than a cotton picker's salary because several key men are ailing.

Everybody on the Miner athletic staff is affected by Mullins' plight. In the spring sports guide, baseball coach Andy Cohen, the old New York Giant, is represented as being as nervous as an alligator in a purse factory over the team's batting.

On the other hand, the pitching appears to be as steady as a new pump handle. Cohen, an old pro who has been around longer than a buffalo nickel, is counting on his pitchers to be as hard to solve as a Chinese chain-letter.

Whittling Contest

According to the press, Cohen works at his job. He stays busier than an Adam's apple at a yodeling match and knows more about baseball than a flea does about a fat dog's back.

Another popular member of the UTEP staff is Assistant Athletic Director Jim Bowden, as welcome on the campus as a footbath is to a mailman.

Also's there's Ross Moore, the trainer, who paved the way for track coach Vandenburg and had things moving like a bubble dancer in a room full of slingshots when the latter arrived. Moore has more energy than a vitamin commercial. He can tape a sore ankle quicker than a monkey can skin a banana.

And finally, not to be ignored is the top man at the El Paso school, Athletic Director George McCarty. He's had his headaches. There was a time when things looked darker than a burned warehouse.

No more. McCarty proved tougher than scrub oak in a whittling contest. Thanks to his drive, his get up and go, UTEP's athletic program today is as solid as Fort Knox.

There's more, but this will give you a sample of Mullins' offerings. Remember he said it, we didn't. All we can be blamed for his keeping out of the wastebasket.

Sorry about that.